

Grammar

Correlative Conjunctions — both...and, either...or, neither...nor, not only...but also

Correlative conjunctions are pairs of words (both...and, either...or, neither...nor, not only...but also) that connect two equal grammatical elements — words, phrases, or clauses — within a sentence. The two connected elements should have the same grammatical form (parallel structure).

Correlative conjunctions (both...and, either...or, neither...nor, not only...but also), bir cümle içinde iki eş değerli unsuru (kelime, öbek ya da cümlecik) birbirine bağlayan çift bağlaçlardır. Bağlanan iki unsur aynı dilbilgisel yapıda olmalıdır (paralel yapı).

When? We use both...and to add two positive ideas equally; either...or to show a choice between two options; neither...nor to negate two ideas together; and not only...but also to emphasise an additional, often stronger, point.

İki olumlu fikri eşit şekilde eklemek için both...and; iki seçenek arasında tercih belirtmek için either...or; iki fikri birlikte olumsuz yapmak için neither...nor; ek ve genellikle daha güçlü bir noktayı vurgulamak için not only...but also kullanılır.

Positive

- Both + A + and + B
- Not only + A + but also + B

Negative

- Neither + A + nor + B

Question

- Is/Are + subject + both + A + and + B?
- Does/Do + subject + either + A + or + B?

Short answers

- Neither do I.
- So does she. (in response to a both...and statement)

Common mistakes

- ~~She is both honest and she is kind.~~ → **She is both honest and kind.**
- ~~He neither likes tea or coffee.~~ → **He likes neither tea nor coffee.**
- ~~Not only she is kind but also generous.~~ → **She is not only kind but also generous.**
- ~~Either you apologise either you leave.~~ → **Either you apologise or you leave.**

1. Choose the correct pair: 'The speech was _____ interesting _____ well delivered.'

- a. either...or
- b. both...and
- c. neither...nor
- d. not...nor

2. You can _____ call me tonight _____ send a message tomorrow.

3. 'He is _____ rude _____ unfriendly; he's actually very polite.' Choose the best pair.

- a. both...and
- b. either...or
- c. neither...nor
- d. not only...but also

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4. 'She is both talented and she works hard' is grammatically correct. — *True / False*

5. Good manners are _____ about words _____ about actions.

6. Put the words in order: is / neither / lazy / nor / dishonest / he

7. Rewrite using both...and: My brother is honest. My brother is kind. (*My brother is...*)

8. Which sentence correctly uses 'not only...but also' with subject-verb inversion?

- a. Not only she is kind, but also generous.
- b. Not only is she kind, but she is also generous.
- c. Not only kind she is, but also generous.
- d. She not only is kind but also is generous is.

9. Combine using neither...nor: The restaurant wasn't cheap. The restaurant wasn't very good. (*The restaurant was...*)